Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From President Lyndon B. Johnson's address to a joint session of Congress on voting rights, 15 March 1965.
At times history and fate meet at a single time in a single place to shape a turning point... So it was at Lexington and Concord. So it was at Selma, Alabama. There, long-suffering men and women peacefully protested the denial of their rights as Americans... It is wrong—deadly wrong—to deny any of your fellow Americans the right to vote in this country.

Source C

Source C: From John Lewis's autobiography, Walking with the Wind, published in 1998, recalling the march on 7 March 1965.
We were walking in pairs, quiet and disciplined. As we reached the crest of the Edmund Pettus Bridge, we saw a wall of blue state troopers. The sheriff, Jim Clark, ordered us to disperse. Within seconds, tear gas canisters were flying, and troopers began lunging on horseback, swinging clubs. I felt a blow to my head and fell. But that terrible violence, captured by the cameras, shocked the conscience of the nation.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
The landmark civil rights laws of the 1960s were ultimately a triumph of presidential leadership. It was President Johnson's masterful political skills and his manipulation of Kennedy's tragic legacy that finally broke the stubborn Southern opposition in Congress to secure equality.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
The landmark legislation of the 1960s was not a gift from the White House, but a prize won through the blood and courage of the grassroots movement. Presidents Kennedy and Johnson were highly cautious politicians who only acted when direct action campaigns in Birmingham and Selma created such severe domestic crises that federal inaction became impossible. The true source of change was the organized masses who made the status quo unsustainable.

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